Eötvös Loránd University
DOCTORAL SCHOOL OF COMPUTER SCIENCE

QUALITY ASSURANCE REGULATIONS AND PLAN

Translation of the original Hungarian text approved by the University Doctoral Council of Eötvös Loránd University at its meeting on 16 October 2025 (Decision No. 7.1).

ELTE Doctoral School of Informatics

Quality Assurance Regulations and Plan

The Quality Assurance Policy and Procedures of ELTE Doctoral School of Informatics (hereinafter referred to as DS) rest upon the principles and regulations laid down in the Doctoral Regulations (hereinafter: Regulations) of Eötvös Loránd University – including the Special Provisions section on the Doctoral School of Informatics –, in the Educational Plan of the Doctoral School, and in the Organizational and Operational Rules of the Doctoral School of Informatics.

The Doctoral School ensures a high standard of the doctoral programme and that of the procedure of obtaining a doctoral degree in accordance with the criteria set out in the Quality Assurance Policy and Plan of the Doctoral School.

Doctoral Council of Informatics, Council of the Doctoral School of Informatics, Head of the Doctoral School

The head of the doctoral school is responsible for the scientific quality and educational work of the doctoral school. The head of the doctoral school, together with the Doctoral Council of Informatics (hereinafter referred to as IDT) and the Doctoral School Council (hereinafter referred to as DOIT), regularly monitors the operation of the doctoral school and ensures its high standard. The tasks and powers of the head of the doctoral school, the Doctoral School Council and the Doctoral Council of Informatics are set out in paragraphs 11, 15 and 16 of the University Doctoral Regulations and in the faculty doctoral regulations.

The head of the doctoral school, the members of DOIT and IDT are professionals who continuously perform high-quality, internationally recognised scientific and teaching activities related to the profile and fields of expertise of DS. DOIT and IDT, as bodies, continuously fulfil the tasks and obligations set out in the regulations at a high level.

Method of quality assurance: Annual summary evaluation based on the ODT database, the MTMT, data provided by stakeholders and the minutes of the councils. Responsible: the chair of the IDT.

Quality policy, quality objectives (ESG 1.1)

The ELTE Doctoral School of Informatics has set the following quality objectives:

Quality objective	Frequency of evaluation	Data source
The proportion of students who pass the comprehensive examination at the end of the 4th semester reaches 70% of the students admitted to the given year.	Annually	Neptun Education System
The proportion of students obtaining a doctoral degree at the end of the 10th semester reaches 50% of the students enrolled in the given year.	annually	Neptun Education System

The proportion of students leaving the programme without taking a comprehensive examination does not exceed 20% on a 3-year average.	annually	Neptun Education System
The percentage of students leaving the programme without obtaining a degree does not exceed 40% on a 3-year average.	annually	Neptun Education System
The lowest admission score for enrolled students is 70 points.	annually	Summary of admission scores
At least 30% of doctoral students completing the programme (8 semesters) participate in successful study abroad programmes within a 5-year period.	annually	Documents relating to doctoral students' study trips
The average grade point average over five years is at least cum laude	annually	The Doctoral School's records of degrees awarded

The Doctoral School of Informatics is part of the ELTE Faculty of Informatics, and the vast majority of its core members, supervisors and lecturers staff members of the faculty. The Faculty provides the Doctoral School with financial resources, infrastructure and the human resources necessary to perform administrative tasks. The Faculty involves Doctoral School students in educational tasks and provides them with high-quality research opportunities through participation in grant projects.

The management of the Doctoral School places particular emphasis on involving student representatives in all aspects of the decision-making process. Doctoral student representatives exercise their right to make proposals and express their opinions through the Doctoral School Council, the Doctoral Council of Informatics, and the Faculty Council of the Faculty of Informatics. In addition, the head of the Doctoral School consults with student representatives as necessary.

The Doctoral School Council is responsible for implementing quality management activities, which are monitored by the Doctoral Council of Informatics on the basis of the report of the head of the Doctoral School.

Annual reporting obligations (ESG 1.1)

Reporting obligations are fulfilled in accordance with the ELTE Doctoral Regulations, the Faculty Doctoral Regulations and the Operational Regulations of the Doctoral School of Informatics.

The Doctoral School reviews its operations annually and prepares a report on its financial, educational, research and other scientific activities to date for the University Doctoral Council (EDT). (The EDT prepares an assessment of the quality of the Doctoral School's operations as part of its annual report, which is prepared in accordance with the quality assurance regulations.

Establishment of doctoral programmes (ESG 1.2)

Any member of the Doctoral School Council may propose the establishment of a doctoral programme in accordance with Section 18. (3) of the University Doctoral Regulations by submitting a training plan and a proposal presenting the new programme, in agreement with the head of the doctoral school. The proposal for the establishment of a doctoral programme must include the professional justification for the doctoral programme and the proposal for the head of the doctoral programme. The proposal accepted by the Doctoral School Council shall be submitted by the head of the doctoral school to the

Doctoral Council of Informatics. The Doctoral School Council and the Doctoral Council of Informatics shall take into account the preliminary opinion of the doctoral students' representatives when making their decision.

Core members, supervisors and lecturers (ESG 1.5)

The core members, supervisors and lecturers of the doctoral school are lecturers and researchers with academic degrees who, based on the recommendation of the Doctoral School Council, are deemed suitable by the Doctoral Council of Informatics to participate in the operation of the Doctoral School. They are expected to engage in continuous high-level scientific activity in the field of science or research of the Doctoral School. Scientific activity must be verified by data registered and continuously updated in the The Hungarian Science Bibliography (Magyar Tudományos Művek Tára, MTMT). .

The professional work of doctoral students and doctoral candidates is supervised by the supervisor. The supervisor provides the doctoral student or doctoral candidate with the necessary professional and methodological knowledge in terms of compulsory and optional study requirements and supervises their research work.

The admission, duties and powers of core members, supervisors and lecturers are regulated by Sections 15 and 17 of the University Doctoral Regulations , the Doctoral School's Operational Regulations and the Doctoral School's Educational Plan.

The IDT and DOIT strive to ensure that the scientific performance and teaching effectiveness of their teaching and thesis supervisor staff continuously improve, and that the number of habilitated staff and high-quality publications increases over a five-year period. The IDT and DOIT aim to have as many talented young lecturers and supervisors (5-10 years after their PhD) as possible in the Doctoral School.

It is expected that DI lecturers and supervisors will be actively involved in the Doctoral School on average over a five-year period.

Quality assurance method: The doctoral school regularly reviews the effectiveness of supervisors and the number of doctoral students supervised by each supervisor. A supervisor may only take on new students if the number of students they supervise in the organised training programme does not exceed six. If a doctoral student does not complete their studies, the programme director conducts an interview about the reasons for their withdrawal, which is reported to the DOIT and IDT bodies. The interview is voluntary on the part of the withdrawn doctoral student.

The heads of the doctoral programmes prepare annual reports on the quality of supervision, which are evaluated by DOIT and IDT, who then take the necessary measures. Student feedback must also be taken into account in the evaluation.

Announcement of topics, admission procedure to the doctoral school (ESG 1.4)

A sufficient number of scientifically demanding topics that can be developed during doctoral training may be announced in the Doctoral School of Informatics. The heads of doctoral programmes make proposals for the topics to be announced in the doctoral school, taking into account current trends in the field. The DOIT discusses the topic proposals and forwards them to the Doctoral Council of Informatics with a recommendation for approval. Only topics approved by the IDT may be announced. After approval by the IDT, the topic is published on the doctoral school's own website and on the website of the Hungarian Doctoral Council. Applications can only be submitted for advertised topics.

Applicants are informed about the requirements and procedure for applying for the doctoral training, the documents to be attached, the application fee and the admission procedure via the Doctoral School's website.

Applicants for doctoral training will be interviewed by a committee of at least three members recommended by the Doctoral School and approved and appointed by the IDT (or, in exceptional cases, its head). The admissions committee will assess the applicants' professional qualifications, language skills, previous academic work, degrees, performance during their university studies, and the feasibility of their research plans. The committee ranks the applicants by scoring them. This ensures that applicants who already have the prerequisite knowledge necessary to begin the programme are admitted to the doctoral programme. Information on the evaluation of applicants is published by the Doctoral School on the website www.felvi.hu and on its own website. The rules governing the announcement of topics and the admission process can be found in Sections 25-28 and 42 of the University Doctoral Regulations and in the Doctoral School's Operational Regulations.

Quality assurance method: Topics may only be announced upon the recommendation of the head of the doctoral programme and with the approval of the DOIT and the IDT. Each year, the heads of the doctoral programmes prepare a summary of the announced topics for the DOIT and IDT council meetings, analysing current scientific trends. The councils analyse the situation and make recommendations. It must be ensured that a sufficient number of topics are announced for the doctoral programmes.

Credit-based study system for doctoral programmes (ESG 1.2)

The credit-based study system set out in the University Doctoral Regulations provides a verifiable framework for the requirements to be met during the programme, encouraging doctoral students to engage in continuous study and research. The study system must be organised in such a way that it is possible to obtain a degree on its basis. State-funded students who do not achieve the required number of credits will be relocated by the Doctoral School to self-financed programmes. By the end of the fourth completed semester, the number of credits specified in Section 9 of the Faculty Doctoral Regulations must be completed in the manner specified in Section 24 of the Regulations, after which a comprehensive examination is mandatory. By the fourth semester, it is mandatory to take at least one course that prepares the student for one of the subjects of the comprehensive examination. After passing the comprehensive examination, no study credits can be earned during the research and dissertation phase. The regulations governing the credit-based study system can be found in the relevant sections of the University Doctoral Regulations, the DS Operational Regulations and the educational Plan.

Quality assurance method: DOIT and IDT review the credit-based study system every year and modify it as necessary. The review takes into account the summary reports of the heads of the doctoral programmes directors, the requests and suggestions of doctoral students, and the suggestions of industrial partners.

Courses (ESG 1.2, 1.9)

Courses may only be launched at the Doctoral School of Informatics with the permission of the Doctoral School Council. Each semester, the Doctoral School Council reviews the list of courses to be advertised and asks lecturers to update the syllabuses, discusses and approves the syllabuses of new courses and, if necessary, requests modifications. It must be ensured that a sufficient number and quality of courses are advertised each semester and in each doctoral programme.

Doctoral students may also apply to take courses advertised outside the Doctoral School. The Doctoral School decides on the creditworthiness of courses based on the course syllabus and the institution offering the course. The regulations governing courses can be found in Sections 37 and 44 of the University Doctoral Regulations, in the DS Operational Regulations and in the DI Educational Plan.

Quality assurance method: The heads of the doctoral programmes encourage lecturers working in the programme to advertise courses. At the end of each semester, the heads of the doctoral programmes present the list of courses to be advertised in the following semester at the DOIT and IDT council meeting. Based on the report prepared by the head of the doctoral programme, DOIT and IDT make recommendations and take measures if necessary.

Study plan, evaluation of student progress (ESG 1.3)

The doctoral students' doctoral study plans and semester study plans are approved by the supervisor and the head of the doctoral programme with their signatures. Supervisors provide assistance in the development of the study plan to ensure that it is realistic and proportionate and serves to acquire the knowledge necessary for the progress of the doctoral student's scientific work. The requirements for the study plan can be found in Section 42 of the University Doctoral Regulations and in the Doctoral School Training Plan.

At the end of each semester, doctoral students prepare a short written report on the fulfilment of their current study obligations within the framework of the doctoral school and their academic achievements to date, which is evaluated by their supervisor with a grade or in text form. The report is approved by the head of the doctoral programme. The supervisor evaluates the doctoral student's progress by commenting on their reports and determining the credit value of the various research tasks. If, based on the report and the number of credits earned, the student is falling behind in their progress, the supervisor will assist them in developing an appropriate study plan.

Quality assurance method: The approval of the supervisor and the head of the relevant doctoral programme is required for the study plan to be accepted. In the event of a dispute, the head of the DS shall decide.

The heads of the doctoral programmesanalyse and evaluate the study plans on an annual basis and report to the DOIT and IDT. The councils discuss the report and make recommendations to the heads of the doctoral programmes.

Preparation of a detailed research plan (ESG 1.3)

After beginning their studies and work on their research topics, doctoral students gain a clearer picture of the tasks to be completed during the four-year programme, so they must prepare a detailed research plan at the end of the first semester in light of their newly acquired experience. The supervisor assists in the development of a detailed research plan to ensure that it is realistic and can be completed on time. The supervisor continuously monitors the doctoral student's research work and provides professional assistance for its implementation. To this end, the supervisor maintains regular contact with the doctoral student, which is documented in writing. The student's progress is assessed by commenting on the student's reports and determining the credit value of the various tasks of the research work.

Quality assurance method: The approval of the supervisor and the head of the relevant doctoral programme is required for the acceptance of the detailed research plan. In case of dispute, the head of the DS shall decide. The programme directors analyse and evaluate the detailed research plans on

an annual basis and report to the DOIT and IDT. The councils discuss the report and make recommendations to the heads of the doctoral programmes.

Training plan (ESG 1.2, 1.9)

The training plan for doctoral programmes must be designed in such a way that it allows doctoral students to develop an individual study plan in line with their research plan, encourages independent, active learning, and prepares students for their future teaching and research roles. In addition, the training plan should provide up-to-date knowledge, help develop the skills necessary for research, be realistic and sufficient for obtaining a degree.

The training plan for doctoral programmes is reviewed annually by the Doctoral School Council in cooperation with student representatives and taking into account the needs of corporate partners. The range of subjects that can be advertised in the Doctoral School must be defined in such a way that it helps students progress and is related to their research topics. Courses that are no longer relevant must be replaced with new courses that are relevant to the field and correspond to the current state of the discipline and the current needs of the profession. At the same time as the training plan is reviewed, the subjects of the comprehensive examination are also reviewed. The review of the training plan and the subjects of the comprehensive examination is coordinated by the head of the Doctoral School. The training plan and the subjects of the comprehensive examination are approved by the Doctoral Council of Informatics.

Quality assurance method: DOIT and IDT review the training plan every year and modify it if necessary. The review takes into account the summary reports of the heads of the doctoral programmes, the requests and suggestions of doctoral students, and the suggestions of industrial partners.

Study abroad (ESG 1.6)

The aim of the Doctoral School is to support doctoral students in their partial training abroad. In order to ensure the quality of study trips and research work abroad, doctoral students must submit a detailed study and research plan in advance and request the approval of the Doctoral School Council. The Doctoral School Council decides on the creditworthiness of studies and research completed during the study trip abroad on the basis of a performance certificate.

Quality assurance method: The DS regularly draws the attention of doctoral students to the possibility of study trips abroad, and supervisors encourage students to undertake study trips abroad. The heads of the doctoral programmes prepare annual summaries for DOIT and IDT based on reports approved by doctoral students' supervisors, which they analyse and provide with recommendations.

Study trips may only be undertaken at institutions that enjoy a positive international reputation and are able to provide the intellectual and material infrastructure necessary for the doctoral student's progress.

Credit verification form (ESG 1.4)

At the end of each semester, doctoral students submit a credit verification form detailing the teaching and research credits they have earned during the semester. The credit verification form must list the publications and presentations on which the credits are based. If they certify research work that does not result in specific findings evaluated with credits (unpublished or unpresented), they must attach a short written report on the content of the research work, signed by their supervisor. On the credit certification form, the supervisor evaluates the student's performance for the semester, and the

content of the form is finalised with the approval of the head of the doctoral programme. The method of credit certification is set out in Section 37 of the University Doctoral Regulations and the DS Operational Regulations.

Method of quality assurance: The head of the doctoral programme draws the supervisor's attention to any anomalies and makes recommendations for their elimination.

Regular reporting by doctoral students (ESG 1.3)

During enrolment, doctoral students submit an updated study and research plan approved by their supervisor, which contains information on the acquisition of the current portion of the 240 credits to be completed during the programme and the schedule for the completion of the research work. The plan to be submitted upon enrolment for the fourth semester shall also include a plan for preparing for the comprehensive examination.

At the end of each semester, the Doctoral School of Informatics reviews the activities and results of doctoral students enrolled in the organised doctoral programme, as well as the results of students who have entered through the comprehensive examination, in order to evaluate and assist the students' work. This takes the form of a short written report prepared by the doctoral students, in which they describe the fulfilment of their current study obligations within the framework of the doctoral school and their scientific results to date, and which is evaluated by their supervisor in the form of a grade or text. The report is approved by the head of the doctoral programme.

In order to monitor the research activities completed during the semesters, the DS continuously collects and records the publications and other public disclosures of the research results of doctoral students. Doctoral students are required to record their published works in the MTMT database.

The method of reporting by students is set out in paragraphs 46-47 of the University Doctoral Regulations, the DS Operational Regulations and the Training Plan.

Quality assurance method: The programme director draws the supervisor's attention to any anomalies and makes recommendations for their elimination. The heads of the doctoral programmesprepare annual summaries of doctoral students' progress and supervisors' performance for DOIT and IDT. The two bodies discuss and comment on the report at a council meeting and, if necessary, make recommendations.

Comprehensive examination (ESG 1.4)

The TNKCs organises the comprehensive examination (complex exam). The IDT decides on the dates of the comprehensive examinations, the professional theoretical subjects relevant to the research topic for each examinee, and the composition of the examination committees based on the DOIT's proposal. The regulations governing the comprehensive examination can be found in Sections 48-55/A of the University Doctoral Regulations, the DS Operational Regulations and the DS Training Plan.

Quality assurance method: Doctoral students take and complete a so-called comprehensive examination preparation course (complex exam preparatory course, mandatory chosen), which corresponds to their research topic and one of the subjects of their comprehensive examination. From the beginning of the third semester, the supervisor pays close attention to the doctoral student's chances of passing the comprehensive examination. After the comprehensive examinations, the head of the DS prepares a summary report for the DOIT and the IDT, analysing the experiences of the comprehensive examinations, including feedback from the doctoral students who took the

examination. The head of the DS, the DOIT and the IDT take the necessary measures based on the report.

Publication requirements (ESG. 1.4)

A prerequisite for submitting a dissertation is that the doctoral candidate, prior to completing their thesis, has two or more papers that attest to their independent scientific work, which are considered prestigious by the profession, have been published in edited scientific journals or volumes, or have been accepted for publication, and which have been written on the topic of the thesis. Doctoral students must continuously record their publications in the MTMT (The Hungarian Science Bibliography) database. At the end of the fourth semester, the programme directors evaluate the research results of the doctoral students, which they do when deciding on their eligibility for the comprehensive examination. The Doctoral School strives to increase the number of doctoral candidates applying for degrees with high-quality publications over a five-year period, as well as the ratio of such publications among all publications accepted during the degree programme. By high-quality publications, we mean publications ranked as SCIMAGO D1, Q1, Q2, CORE A*, A, B.

Quality assurance method: Development of an incentive system for the creation of high-quality publications.

Annual and five-year evaluation of the publication performance of students applying for a degree and taking the necessary measures by the head of the doctoral programme, DOIT and IDT.

Requirements for obtaining a degree (ESG. 1.4)

The detailed requirements of the doctoral procedure are set out in the University Doctoral Regulations and its annex containing the specific features of the Doctoral School of Informatics, as well as in the DS Operational Regulations.

DOIT discusses in detail the applications submitted for the initiation of the doctoral procedure, and the head of the relevant doctoral programme or a member of DOIT appointed by the head of DS, who is knowledgeable in the field (the reviewer), who will examine the submitted application in advance and determine whether it meets the requirements of the doctoral procedure. The supervisor and the head of the doctoral programme of the doctoral candidate applying for the degree must make a joint written statement recommending the initiation of the doctoral procedure and the submission of the dissertation.

The doctoral dissertation is evaluated in a research center disputation prior to its submission. As part of the research center disputation, an external and an internal reviewer prepare a written opinion on the dissertation. The minutes of the research center disputation shall be attached to the thesis upon submission. The research center disputation is public and shall be announced on the doctoral school's website.

After the thesis has been submitted, the DOIT shall give its opinion and, before appointing the defence committee, the IDT shall decide on the acceptance of the thesis and the continuation of the procedure, taking into account the recommendations contained in the opinion.

As part of the official doctoral procedure, an internal and an external opponent prepare a review of the doctoral candidates' dissertations. The defence is public, and the doctoral dissertation and its theses are available on the DS website prior to the defence.

Quality assurance method: Development of an incentive system. Annual and five-yearly evaluation of the performance of degree holders and implementation of necessary measures by the programme director, DOIT and IDT.

Student complaints, feedback, follow-up (ESG 1.3)

Doctoral students may address their complaints to their supervisor, the head of the relevant doctoral programme and the head of the DS, either verbally or in writing. Verbal complaints must be made during the announced office hours. Written complaints may also be submitted by e-mail. The addressee of the complaint shall take action to investigate the complaint. If the complaint is justified, the competent body or official of the DS shall take action to remedy it.

At the end of each semester, doctoral students evaluate the courses held within the framework of the DS. The DS uses a survey prepared by the ELTE Quality Office for the evaluation.

The head of the DS informs the DOIT and IDT of the results of the evaluation. The members of the two bodies discuss the feedback at a council meeting and take the necessary measures.

The DS holds a public Doctoral School Forum every semester, where the head of the DS answers questions and requests from doctoral students. The Doctoral School Forum must be announced on the DS website at least three weeks in advance.

Graduates are followed up through the ELTE Alumni organisation.

Information management (ESG 1.7)

At the end of each semester, the Doctoral School Council reviews the activities, academic, research and publication performance of doctoral students enrolled in the organised doctoral programme, as well as the results of students entering through the comprehensive examination, for the purpose of evaluating and assisting the work of students.

In addition, at its annual meeting, the Doctoral School Council reviews

- the number and composition of applicants for doctoral training, the admission results of doctoral students who have been admitted,
- the number of students who complete their studies without passing a comprehensive examination, obtaining an absolutorium or degree, and the reasons for premature termination of studies. Based on the evaluation, the Doctoral School Council of the Doctoral School of Informatics initiates intervention, if necessary, to improve the effectiveness of the programme.
- The DOIT also examines student feedback on the quality of training.

The Doctoral School also monitors, to the extent possible, the career paths of doctoral students who have obtained their degrees, particularly those who have chosen a career in teaching and research.

Providing information, public information (ESG 1.8)

All information required by doctoral students and interested parties, as set out in the regulations, must be available on the DS website. The forms required for administrative procedures must also be available. The information and forms must be available in both Hungarian and English.

The Doctoral School's website provides detailed information, particularly on

- the Doctoral School's data,

- the bodies of the Doctoral School,
- the regulations governing the programme,
- the doctoral programmes,
- the conditions for applying to the Doctoral School and the admission procedure
- doctoral training (academic calendar, enrolment, registration, credit acquisition, reporting, doctoral topic change, foreign language requirements, comprehensive examination, absolutorium)
- the process of obtaining a degree.

At the beginning of each academic year, the head of the DS gives a presentation to doctoral students on the operation and structure of the doctoral school, the training requirements and how to fulfil them.

The DS holds an Open Day every semester. On the Open Day, the head of the DS gives a brief overview of the doctoral school, DS lecturers give presentations on their topics, and former students who have obtained a degree in the DS give reports.